[fn29] The mark on the *h* of Planck's constant serves only to indicate that Planck's constant is in this equation divided by 2π, a rather useless and idiosyncratic addition by theoretical physicists: placing the small, hard, angular mark on the *h* 'makes it elegant'.

[fn30] To hear this metaphor directly in his own voice, go to the site http://www.webofstories.com/play/9542?o=MS.

[fn31] DeWitt replaces derivatives with derivative operators in the Hamilton–Jacobi equation for general relativity (written a little while earlier by Peres). That is, he does what Schrödinger had done to write his equation, in his first work: replacing derivatives with derivative operators in the Hamilton–Jacobi equation of a particle.

[fn32] Or the 'Einstein–Schrödinger' equation.

[fn33] The best known alternative to loop quantum gravity is string theory, whose main concern is not so much studying the quantum properties of space and time, but rather writing a unified theory of all known fields, an objective that might be premature given current knowledge.